Burdizzo Castrator



Category: **Animal Husbandry & Dairy** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Burdizzo castrator

What it is used for

A Burdizzo castrator is a specialised clamp used by trained veterinary or livestock professionals to crush the spermatic cords during an approved bloodless castration procedure. Correct animal selection, anatomical knowledge, hygiene, pain management, and aftercare are essential for animal welfare and procedural safety.

Main parts

- Clamp jaws apply controlled compression to the targeted tissue.
- Handle arms provide leverage to operate the clamp.
- Hinge or pivot connects the handle arms.
- Locking mechanism holds the clamp position where fitted.
- Grip surfaces help the operator maintain control.
- Identification or size markings may help select the appropriate instrument.
- Cleaning and storage case protects the instrument between uses.

Before you start

1. Only a veterinarian or specifically trained and legally authorised livestock professional should perform the procedure.
2. Confirm the animal's identity, age, health, suitability, and applicable veterinary requirements before proceeding.
3. Explain the procedure and ensure an approved pain-management and aftercare plan is in place.
4. Inspect the clamp for damaged jaws, loose joints, corrosion, or unreliable movement.
5. Prepare suitable restraint, clean supplies, and a hygienic working area.
6. Confirm the instrument is cleaned, disinfected or sterilised as required by its instructions and the approved veterinary protocol.

How to use

1. Restrain the animal using the approved method to minimise movement and distress.
2. Confirm the correct anatomical landmarks and procedure plan before applying the instrument.
3. Use the prescribed pain-management and hygiene measures before starting.
4. Position the clamp only as directed by the approved veterinary technique and instrument instructions.
5. Apply compression in the specified manner without improvising placement or duration.
6. Complete the procedure according to the veterinary protocol and release the animal only when safe.

7. Observe the animal for distress, bleeding, swelling, abnormal movement, or other complications.
8. Provide the prescribed aftercare and clear instructions for follow-up monitoring.
9. Record the animal identification, procedure date, operator, pain management, and observations.
10. Clean and maintain the instrument according to its instructions after use.

⚠ Safety

- Never use a Burdizzo castrator without formal training and authorisation.
- Do not attempt the procedure on an unsuitable or unassessed animal.
- Do not guess clamp placement, force, or application duration; follow the approved veterinary technique.
- Use appropriate animal restraint and avoid placing hands in crushing zones.
- Stop and seek veterinary assistance if complications, severe distress, or uncertainty occurs.
- Follow local animal-welfare law and veterinary guidance, including pain relief and post-procedure monitoring.

Care & storage

- Clean the instrument promptly after use and disinfect or sterilise it as specified.
- Dry the instrument thoroughly before storage to reduce corrosion.
- Inspect the jaws, hinge, handles, and locking mechanism before each use.
- Store the clamp in a clean, dry, protected case and arrange servicing if it does not operate reliably.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using the instrument without appropriate training or veterinary authorisation.
- Applying the clamp without confirming anatomical landmarks.
- Ignoring pain management, hygiene, or follow-up care.
- Failing to monitor the animal for complications after the procedure.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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